

Q1 2026 Benefit Report: Event Attendance (OSC)

Executive Summary

Q1 2026 event attendance by Open Source Committee (OSC) representatives delivered measurable governance, program, and ecosystem value across multiple geographies and audience segments. Participation at BuidlerFest Argentina, FOSDEM/CHAOScon EU, Game Developers Conference, and Cardano Africa Tech Summit (CATS) extended OSC's role beyond representation into active program validation, ecosystem intelligence gathering, and strategic pipeline development.

Across all events, a consistent pattern emerged: **POSM** is understood as a **differentiated and necessary** model, but requires continued refinement in positioning, intake mechanisms, and developer-facing clarity. Attendance to these events functioned as an operational extension of OSC mandate—directly informing program evolution, strengthening institutional relationships, and expanding contributor and partner pipelines.

Key Benefits by Event

FOSDEM & CHAOScon EU (February 2026)

Primary Value: Institutional positioning + funding model validation

- OSC Chair presented on open source funding models
- Facilitated discussions with EU institutions, Ethereum Foundation, and funding bodies

Key Benefits

- **Established OSC as a thought leader in open source sustainability**
 - Limited blockchain presence created a clear positioning advantage
- **Validated POSM at institutional level**
 - Strong alignment with EU Sovereign Tech Fund and public infrastructure funding models
- **Created high-value institutional connections**
 - Ethereum Foundation, Sovereign Tech Fund, and related actors
- **Enabled OSO follow-through**
 - Relationships transitioned from conversation to ongoing engagement

Impact: This event positioned OSC beyond Cardano—as part of the global conversation on funding open source infrastructure, opening pathways for institutional alignment and long-term collaboration.

Game Developers Conference (GDC) (March 2026)

Primary Value: External market validation + new audience expansion

- Engagement with game developers, blockchain ecosystems, and open source communities
- Participation in networking events and open mic discussions

Key Benefits

- **Validated developer priorities outside Cardano**
 - Governance, trust, and sustainability are key adoption drivers
- **Tested POSM messaging in a non-Cardano environment**
 - Framing POSM as infrastructure support (not blockchain-specific) resonated
- **Expanded ecosystem reach**
 - Connections with Sui and broader developer communities
- **Engaged early-stage developers**
 - Open mic participation introduced open source sustainability concepts to new entrants

Impact: GDC confirmed that POSM is not niche—it is portable and relevant across ecosystems, especially when framed around developer trust and long-term platform stability.

BuidlerFest Argentina (March 2026)

Primary Value: Program validation + actionable design improvements

- OSC Members presented POSM to a highly technical Cardano builder audience
- Hosted open session on open source practices
- Direct engagement with maintainers, developers, and ecosystem contributors

Key Benefits

- **Validated core POSM programs**
 - Maintainer Retainer and Tooling Sustainability clearly resonated with real-world maintainer challenges
- **Identified critical program gaps**
 - Over-reliance on self-attestation scripts is excluding valid projects
 - Need for case-by-case evaluation pathways
- **Surfaced new evaluation criteria**
 - CLI usability and *agent AI readiness* as emerging requirements for tooling relevance
- **Captured real maintainer risk signals**
 - Example: Gamechanger Wallet highlighting burnout and single-maintainer fragility

Impact: This event directly improved how POSM should operate, not just how it is communicated. It exposed failure points in intake and evaluation that can now be corrected.



Cardano Africa Tech Summit (CATS) (February 2026)

Developer Advocate Reports: [Dan](#) [Uche](#) [Emmanuel](#) [Harun](#)

Primary Value: Developer pipeline growth + onboarding insights

- Developer Advocates engaged directly with African developer communities
- Activities included mentoring, speaking, and ecosystem onboarding

Key Benefits

- **Expanded developer pipeline in emerging markets**
 - Direct access to high-growth, under-supported developer communities
- **Validated onboarding gap**
 - Events generate interest, but lack structured pathways to convert developers into contributors
- **Reinforced Developer Advocate role**
 - Critical as “connective layer” between events and sustained participation
- **Strengthened university and grassroots engagement model**
 - Clear opportunity to align with local educators, ambassadors, and community leaders

Impact: CATS demonstrated that growth is not limited by awareness—it is limited by structured onboarding and follow-through, directly informing Developer Advocate and DevEx priorities.

Cross-Event Strategic Insights

1. POSM is Validated, But Intake Must Evolve

- Strong demand for:
 - Maintainer Retainer
 - Tooling Sustainability
- Required changes:
 - Introduce case-by-case evaluation alongside automation
 - Improve clarity of eligibility and entry points

2. Developer Experience is the Primary Constraint

- Consistent signals across all events:
 - Fragmented tooling
 - Poor onboarding pathways
 - Lack of unified documentation
- Emerging requirements:
 - CLI-first tooling
 - AI/agent-compatible ecosystems

3. Events Generate Demand — But Not Conversion

- Repeated pattern:
 - High interest at events
 - Low structured follow-through
- Required response:
 - Developer Advocates as conversion layer
 - Clear onboarding funnels into POSM programs

4. OSC's Role is Expanding Beyond Cardano

- Increasing relevance in:
 - Cross-chain collaboration
 - Institutional funding discussions
 - Open source sustainability leadership

Outlook

Event participation should remain a core part of OSC strategy, with a shift toward:

- Structured post-event conversion (Developer Advocates + OSO)
- Refined program intake and onboarding pathways
- Targeted attendance where developer onboarding and institutional alignment are highest

Q1 confirms: event attendance is not outreach—it is program development, validation, and pipeline generation in practice.